

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3300

Name

Vasavi Prakash

Emailvprakash@auburn.edu**Gender**

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Auburn,AL, US

Nationality

India

When did or will you finish your PhD?

2024

University Education

PhD| Wildlife Ecology| Auburn University, US| Dec 2024

PGD| Geoinformatics| University of Twente, Netherlands| 2017

MS| Forestry| Forestry Research Institute, India| 2015

MS| Biochemistry| Banaras Hindu University, India| 2010

BS| Zoology and Biochemistry| St. Xavier's College, India| 2008

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

As an aspiring Science Corps fellow, I am driven by a deep passion for science education and a strong commitment to making a positive impact in underserved communities. My motivation to apply stems from a desire to share my love for science and to inspire the next generation of scientists,

particularly in regions where access to quality STEM education may be limited.

I believe that science education is a powerful tool for empowering individuals and communities. It fosters critical thinking, problem-solving skills, and curiosity, all of which are essential for addressing global challenges. By becoming a Science Corps fellow, I have the opportunity to contribute to this mission by bringing hands-on, engaging science education to students who may not otherwise have the chance to explore these subjects in depth.

Furthermore, I am eager to immerse myself in a new cultural context, where I can learn from diverse perspectives and collaborate with local educators to develop curricula that are both scientifically rigorous and culturally relevant. I am excited about the prospect of adapting my teaching methods to meet the needs of students from different backgrounds and helping to create a lasting impact by building local capacity in STEM education.

Ultimately, my goal as a Science Corps fellow is to make science more accessible and exciting for students, to contribute to the development of sustainable educational programs, and to grow as an educator and global citizen. This fellowship represents a unique opportunity to combine my passion for science, education, and community service, and I am enthusiastic about the possibility of being part of this transformative experience.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

In addition to my studies, I have engaged in several experiences that have significantly prepared me for a Science Corps fellowship. These experiences have equipped me with the skills necessary to teach science effectively, work collaboratively in diverse environments, and contribute meaningfully to educational programs in underserved communities.

First, my experience as a teaching assistant for various science courses has been instrumental in developing my teaching skills. In this role, I have had the opportunity to lead lab sessions, facilitate group discussions, and mentor students individually. This has honed my ability to explain complex scientific concepts in accessible ways and to adapt my teaching methods to accommodate different learning styles. It has also instilled in me a deep appreciation for the importance of fostering a supportive and inclusive learning environment, which I believe is critical for engaging students in STEM.

Additionally, I have volunteered with several community outreach programs that aim to promote science education among underrepresented groups. For example, I worked with a local school to design and deliver interactive workshops for middle and high school students. These workshops focused on hands-on activities that encouraged students to explore scientific principles through experimentation and observation. This experience taught me how to create engaging and educational content that resonates with young learners, even those who may initially be disinterested or intimidated by science.

I have also participated in a research project that involved collaborating with an international team of scientists and educators. We worked on developing a curriculum that integrates traditional ecological knowledge with modern scientific practices for use in schools in rural areas. This project provided me with valuable experience in cross-cultural communication and collaboration, as well as insight into the challenges and opportunities of implementing

science education programs in different cultural contexts.

Lastly, I have served as a mentor for a STEM outreach program for high school students interested in pursuing careers in science and technology. Through this program, I have guided students to science fairs and offered advice on college applications and career paths. This mentorship experience has reinforced my commitment to supporting the next generation of scientists and my belief in the transformative power of education.

These experiences have collectively prepared me to contribute effectively as a Science Corps fellow. I am excited about the opportunity to bring my skills and enthusiasm for science education to a new setting, where I can help inspire students and work towards closing the educational gap in STEM.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Doing science in industry

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

In reflecting on my experiences that have prepared me for a Science Corps fellowship, I see a clear trajectory for my professional future, both in the near term (two years) and the long term (ten years).

Near-Term (Two-Year) Vision:

In the next two years, I envision myself deeply engaged in educational initiatives that combine my passion for science with my commitment to community service. As a Science Corps fellow, I would immerse myself in a new cultural and educational environment, focusing on delivering high-quality, hands-on science education to students who may have limited access to such opportunities. My goal is to make science engaging and accessible, helping students develop critical thinking skills and foster a genuine curiosity about the natural world.

During this time, I aim to gain valuable experience in curriculum development and teaching strategies that are culturally responsive and tailored to diverse learning needs. I also anticipate building strong relationships with local educators, collaborating to create sustainable educational programs that can continue to benefit the community long after my fellowship ends. This experience will not only enhance my teaching abilities but also expand my understanding of global education challenges and opportunities.

Long-Term (Ten-Year) Vision:

Looking ahead to the next ten years, I see myself as a leader in science education, leveraging the skills and insights gained from the Science Corps fellowship and subsequent experiences. My long-term goal is to contribute to systemic change in STEM education, particularly in underserved

communities, both domestically and internationally.

Professionally, I aspire to be in a position where I can influence science education policy and curriculum development on a broader scale. This could be through a role in an educational nonprofit organization, a governmental education department, or an international development agency focused on education. In this capacity, I would advocate for inclusive and equitable science education practices, work to integrate culturally relevant pedagogy, and promote the importance of science literacy in solving global challenges.

I also envision contributing to academic research on science education, particularly exploring innovative teaching methods and their impact on diverse student populations. By publishing my findings and sharing best practices, I hope to influence other educators and contribute to the ongoing dialogue about improving STEM education globally.

In addition to these professional goals, I am passionate about mentoring the next generation of educators and scientists. In ten years, I hope to be involved in training and supporting new teachers, helping them to develop their skills and encouraging them to bring their unique perspectives and backgrounds into their teaching. By fostering a community of passionate and well-prepared educators, I believe we can create lasting change in the way science is taught and perceived around the world.

In summary, I see my journey with the Science Corps as a pivotal step toward a future where I can make meaningful contributions to science education, advocate for educational equity, and inspire others to pursue careers in STEM. Through both direct teaching and broader systemic efforts, I am committed to working towards a world where all students have the opportunity to explore and excel in science, regardless of their background or circumstances.

CV/Resume

 [Vasavi-Prakash-CV-Aug2024.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

A friend or colleague

Any other comments/questions?

Empty

[Science Corps](#)